NAFTA & The Contract with America

1992 & 1994

Source: NAFTA Preamble (1992) and Contract with America (1994). Public domain. Continuous passages.

> Two defining documents of the 1990s: NAFTA created a North American free-trade zone linking the U.S., Canada, and Mexico, while the Contract with America laid out the House Republicans' agenda that swept them to a majority in 1994.

[NAFTA] The Government of Canada, the Government of the United Mexican States and the Government of the United States of America, resolved to: . . . Create an expanded and secure market for the goods and services produced in their territories; Reduce distortions to trade; Establish clear and mutually advantageous rules governing their trade.

[. . .]

[Contract with America] As Republican Members of the House of Representatives and as citizens seeking to join that body we propose not just to change its policies, but even more important, to restore the bonds of trust between the people and their elected representatives. . . . That historic change would be the end of government that is too big, too intrusive, and too easy with the public's money.